

Top 10 Left Handed Arms in the 2027 Draft

One of the most surprising conclusions from evaluating 53 draft-eligible Division I pitchers was not the quality of the right-handed pitching at the top of the board. It was the depth of the left-handed pitching behind it.

Most draft classes can point to one or two standout southpaws. The 2027 class offers considerably more than that. At the top are potential early-round talents with frontline starter aspirations. Beneath them sits an unusually deep collection of pitchers who win in very different ways. Some rely on power stuff and premium velocity. Others succeed through command, deception, movement diversity, and advanced pitchability. Together, they form one of the strongest groups of collegiate left-handed pitching in recent memory.

What makes the class especially intriguing is the lack of a single defining archetype. Dylan Volantis built his profile around one of the best curveballs in the country. Tomas Valincius attacks hitters with a power sinker-slider combination and a starter's workload already on his résumé. Rhys Bowie possesses some of the loudest raw stuff in amateur baseball. Meanwhile, pitchers such as Cole Gibler, Charlie Foster, Henry Zatkowski, and Cooper Williams create value through vastly different movement profiles, release characteristics, and developmental pathways.

The depth extends beyond the obvious names. Several pitchers in this group project as future starters despite possessing very different strengths, while others have the ingredients to take significant developmental steps over the next season. That variety is ultimately what separates the class. Professional organizations are not simply choosing between a handful of similar left-handed arms. They are selecting from a wide range of profiles capable of providing value in different ways.

These are my Top 10 left-handed pitchers entering the 2027 season.

Number 10: Masson Brassfield, TCU

2026 Stats: 6.24 ERA / 49.0 IP / 1.776 WHIP / 69 K / 28 BB / 2.46 K:BB

Best Pitch: Slider (55/60)

Brassfield earns the final spot on this list because few left-handed pitchers in the class combine his physicality, arm strength, and a plus slider. The 2026 results were inconsistent, particularly against right-handed hitters, but the underlying traits remain those of a pitcher professional organizations will continue to bet on.

The slider is the carrying pitch and the primary reason Brassfield remains in the discussion. It already projects as an above-average professional offering and gives him a legitimate weapon capable of generating swing-and-miss against both handedness groups. In a class loaded with quality southpaws, having a breaking ball that can finish at-bats remains an important separator.

What holds the profile back currently is the lack of a reliable complement against right-handed hitters. The fastball flashes quality traits, and the sinker provides another look, but neither consistently showed the execution necessary to support a stronger starter projection. The development of the changeup will likely determine whether Brassfield remains a back-end starter candidate or develops into something more.

Why #10: Brassfield is ranked here because of the combination of left-handed velocity, a legitimate plus breaking ball, and remaining developmental upside. The pitchers ranked ahead of him possess either stronger present performance, more complete repertoires, or greater starter certainty, but few left-handed arms in the class offer the same combination of raw ingredients and projection.

Number 9: Charlie Foster, Ole Miss

2026 Stats: 6.69 ERA | 36.1 IP | 1.651 WHIP | 37 K | 22 BB

Best Pitch: Changeup (50/60)

Foster enters 2027 with one of the more unusual left-handed profiles in the class. Working from a tall frame with a high release point and slight crossfire delivery, he creates uncomfortable angles to the plate while attacking hitters with a four-pitch mix built around an excellent split-change. The raw production was inconsistent in 2026, but the underlying traits remain appealing.

The changeup is the carrying pitch and the primary reason Foster makes this list. It already projects as an above-average professional offering, generating both chase and swing-and-miss while consistently producing poor contact. More importantly, it gives Foster a reliable answer against right-handed hitters, a necessity for any left-hander hoping to remain in a professional rotation.

What separates Foster from several of the pitchers ranked behind him is arsenal depth. While the changeup is the clear headliner, the fastball, cutter, and curveball all provide enough utility to support a starter projection. None currently project as dominant weapons, but together they create multiple pathways for outs and allow Foster to attack hitters in different ways.

The biggest question entering 2027 is role. The frame appears relatively mature, the command remains inconsistent, and there are arguments that the profile could ultimately fit best in a multi-inning relief role. At the same time, the quality of the changeup and overall depth of the repertoire give him a legitimate opportunity to hold a spot in a professional rotation if the strike throwing improves.

Why #9: Foster earns the ranking because of the changeup, arsenal depth, and remaining starter projection. The pitchers ranked above him either possess louder stuff or greater certainty, but few left-handers in the class combine a plus offspeed pitch with a four-pitch mix as effectively as Foster.

Number 8: Max Stammel, Virginia

2026 Stats: 7.55 ERA | 56.0 IP | 1.661 WHIP | 62 K | 28 BB

Best Pitch: Changeup (55/60)

Stammel earns his spot on this list because he presents hitters with one of the most unusual visual looks among left-handed starters in the class. Working from a low arm slot, he creates extreme horizontal angles while pairing that release with a deep pitch mix and a legitimate above-average changeup. The overall results were uneven in 2026, but the underlying traits remain fascinating from a professional development perspective.

The release characteristics drive much of the profile. The fastball approaches hitters from a difficult angle, particularly against left-handed batters, while the changeup further exaggerates that effect with over 20 inches of arm-side movement. Rather than overpowering hitters with velocity, Stammel forces them to navigate uncomfortable approach angles and movement patterns throughout the at-bat.

The changeup is the carrying pitch and the main reason he remains one of the more intriguing left-handed arms in the class. It gives him a legitimate weapon against right-handed hitters and allows the entire arsenal to play above its raw characteristics. When paired with the lower release height, the pitch creates some of the most extreme east-west movement in the class and consistently generates uncomfortable swing decisions.

What keeps Stammel from climbing higher is the lack of a true finishing breaking ball. The cutter, slider, and curveball all provide utility, but none currently serve as a consistent put-away weapon. The profile instead relies on deception, movement diversity, and sequencing to turn lineups over.

Why #8: Stammel earns this ranking because unusual angle-driven profiles from the left side are worth betting on, especially when paired with a legitimate carrying changeup. The pitchers ranked above him offer louder stuff, cleaner performance, or greater starter certainty, but few left-handers in the class create a more uncomfortable visual challenge for opposing hitters.

Number 7: Henry Zatkowski, Virginia

2026 Stats: 4.57 ERA | 84.2 IP | 1.181 WHIP | 96 K | 25 BB

Best Pitch: Sweeper (50/55)

Zatkowski earns his place on this list because he presents one of the most difficult visual challenges for hitters in the entire class. Working from an exceptionally low arm slot, he attacks the plate from angles few collegiate pitchers can replicate while maintaining a starter's workload across nearly 85 innings. The profile is built around deception, movement diversity, and forcing hitters into uncomfortable swing decisions rather than overwhelming them with velocity.

The lower arm angle gives every pitch in the arsenal additional value. The fastball enters from an unusual approach angle, the sweeper creates extreme east-west movement, and the changeup amplifies that movement profile even further. Unlike many low-slot pitchers who become overly reliant on horizontal movement, Zatkowski presents hitters with multiple shapes and velocity bands, making it difficult to eliminate any one pitch.

The sweeper and changeup form the foundation of the arsenal. Both project as above-average offerings and play significantly above their raw movement characteristics because of the release point and angle created by the delivery. Combined with a willingness to attack the strike zone and carry a starter's workload, they provide a realistic path toward a professional role.

The profile lacks the pure stuff of the pitchers ranked ahead of him, but few left-handed pitchers in the class create as much discomfort from release characteristics alone. In an era increasingly focused on movement profiles and approach angles, Zatkowski offers one of the more distinctive looks in the 2027 class.

Why #7: Zatkowski earns this ranking because of his combination of durability, deception, and unusual release characteristics. The pitchers ranked above him generally possess louder stuff or more complete repertoires, but few left-handers force hitters to solve as many movement and angle problems within a single at-bat.

Number 6: Ethan Lund, Oklahoma State

2026 Stats: 5.34 ERA | 84.1 IP | 1.411 WHIP | 137 K | 53 BB

Best Pitch: Curveball (55/60)

Lund ranks this highly because few left-handed pitchers in the class can match his combination of size, stuff, and strikeout production. Standing 6-foot-6 with a fastball that reaches the upper-90s and a pair of legitimate breaking balls, he possesses many of the traits professional organizations covet in a starter. The challenge throughout 2026 was not missing bats. It was consistently getting to favorable counts and limiting damage when command escaped him.

The curveball is the centerpiece of the arsenal. Generating a 51% whiff rate and accounting for 57 strikeouts during the season, the pitch routinely functioned as his primary finishing weapon. Its steep downer shape creates difficult swing decisions and gives Lund a reliable put-away offering against both handedness groups. Few left-handed pitchers in the class can match the raw swing-and-miss characteristics of the pitch.

The fastball further raises the ceiling. Lund combines above-average ride, good velocity, and a difficult release profile, creating a pitch capable of generating whiffs at the top of the strike zone. When paired with the curveball, the combination gives hitters drastically different movement planes to account for. The issue is not quality. It is consistency. Too many misses turned into walks, and too many mistakes over the plate turned into damage.

That volatility is ultimately what defines the profile. Lund struck out 137 hitters in 84.1 innings, one of the highest totals among pitchers evaluated for this project. At the same time, the 53 walks illustrate why the profile remains less certain than some of the names ranked above him.

Why #6: Lund earns this ranking because the raw ingredients are difficult to ignore. The curveball is one of the best among left-handed pitchers in the class, the fastball possesses professional traits, and the frame supports a starter projection. The pitchers ranked above him offer greater certainty, but few left-handers in the class possess the same combination of upside and swing-and-miss ability.

Number 5: Matthew Shorey, Vanderbilt

2026 Stats: 3.00 ERA | 6.0 IP | 0.833 WHIP | 8 K | 2 BB

Best Pitch: Fastball (50/55)

Shorey is one of the more projection-heavy placements on this list, but the underlying ingredients are difficult to ignore. The Vanderbilt left-hander works from a low three-quarter slot with a pronounced crossfire delivery, creating unusual horizontal angles that make hitters uncomfortable from the moment the ball leaves his hand. While the collegiate sample is limited, the movement profile, deception, and arsenal construction all point toward a pitcher with legitimate starter traits.

The fastball serves as the foundation of the profile. Despite operating around 91 mph, the pitch consistently plays above its velocity because of the release characteristics and exceptional horizontal approach. The combination of angle, carry, and deception generated a 30% whiff rate in 2026 and gives Shorey a weapon capable of missing bats at the top of the strike zone. Few pitchers on this list rely on release characteristics as heavily as Shorey, and the fastball is the clearest example of how well that approach can work.

The rest of the arsenal fits together naturally. The sweeper creates substantial east-west separation off the fastball, while the changeup mirrors the release characteristics and allows him to attack opposite-handed hitters. None of the secondary offerings currently project as dominant standalone pitches, but together they create a coherent arsenal built around movement, angle, and deception rather than pure velocity. The biggest challenge is proving the profile over a larger workload. With only six collegiate innings in 2026, much of the projection remains forward-looking rather than performance-driven. Additional innings and physical development will determine how much the stuff holds over a starter's workload, but the foundational traits are already apparent.

Why #5: Shorey ranks this highly because unusual angle-driven left-handed arms are worth betting on, particularly when the movement profiles complement each other as cleanly as they do here. The pitchers ranked above him have either stronger resumes or louder present stuff, but few left-handers in the class possess a more intriguing combination of deception, movement, and projection.

Number 4: Cole Gibler, Arkansas

2026 Stats: 5.46 ERA | 59.1 IP | 59 K | 25 BB | 2.36 K:BB

Best Pitch: Slider (50/50)

Gibler earns this ranking because of the overall starter foundation he brings to the table. While the pure stuff does not match the elite ceilings of some left-handers in the class, he combines a quality three-pitch mix with a unique release profile and enough strike-throwing ability to project comfortably in a professional rotation. The profile is less about overwhelming hitters and more about presenting difficult angles and multiple movement patterns over a starter's workload.

The slider is the carrying pitch and the primary reason he ranks this highly. Despite below-average raw spin for a modern breaking ball, the pitch generates consistent swing-and-miss through depth, angle, and location. Gibler repeatedly showed the ability to land the pitch down and glove side, where the shape became particularly effective against right-handed hitters. It is not the flashiest breaking ball in the class, but it consistently generated the outcomes expected from a professional secondary.

The changeup further strengthens the profile. The offering creates substantial separation from the fastball and serves as a viable answer against right-handed hitters. Combined with the slider, it gives Gibler two distinct pitches capable of generating uncomfortable swing decisions rather than forcing him to rely exclusively on the fastball.

What ultimately elevates the profile is the delivery and release characteristics. Gibler starts on the third-base side of the rubber and works aggressively across his body, creating unusual angles that make the arsenal play above the radar gun. The approach is particularly effective against same-sided hitters and gives every pitch in the mix additional deception.

Why #4: Gibler earns this ranking because of the combination of starter projection, arsenal depth, and role certainty. While some pitchers on this list may possess louder individual traits, Gibler offers a balanced three-pitch mix, a deceptive release profile, and multiple pathways to remaining in a professional rotation. The overall profile is built more on sustainability than pure flash, giving him one of the stronger long-term starter outlooks among the left-handed pitchers in the class.

Number 3: Rhys Bowie, Wake Forest

2026 Stats: 5.22 ERA | 39.2 IP | 1.639 WHIP | 69 K | 32 BB

Best Pitch: Curveball (70)

Bowie ranks this highly because no other left-handed pitcher in the class combines his raw stuff, movement diversity, and pure ceiling. The profile is built around two double-plus breaking balls, three legitimate fastball looks, and some of the loudest velocity from the left side in amateur baseball. While the command remains inconsistent and the starter projection is less certain than the pitchers ranked ahead of him, the overall arsenal is simply too powerful to ignore.

The curveball is the headline pitch and the best breaking ball in the class. It pairs elite spin with uncommon velocity and a movement profile that combines both plus depth and plus sweep. What makes the pitch especially impressive is that it achieves those traits from a lower release point than most power curveballs, creating a look few hitters are accustomed to seeing. The results matched the shape, generating a 58% whiff rate while limiting opponents to a .174 batting average. Few amateur pitches can match its combination of movement, command, and swing-and-miss ability.

Beyond the curveball, Bowie possesses one of the deepest arsenals in the class. The four-seam fastball, sinker, and cutter all project as professional offerings, while the cutter itself has an argument as one of the best individual pitches in the entire draft class. That depth gives him answers against hitters from both sides of the plate and creates multiple pathways toward success.

What ultimately separates Bowie from the pitchers ranked below him is ceiling. There are legitimate concerns about command consistency and role projection, but there are very few left-handed pitchers in the country capable of matching the sheer quality of his arsenal when everything is working.

Why #3: Bowie owns the loudest pure stuff among the left-handed pitchers in the class and features two double-plus breaking balls. The pitchers ranked ahead of him offer greater starter certainty, but no southpaw in the 2027 class possesses a higher raw ceiling.

Number 2: Dylan Volantis, Texas

2026 Stats: 2.08 ERA | 95.0 IP | 1.000 WHIP | 135 K | 28 BB

Best Pitch: Curveball (65/70)

Volantis ranks near the top of this list because few left-handed pitchers in the class possess a profile as complete or as proven. While many prospects derive their value from one elite trait, Volantis combines workload, durability, swing-and-miss ability, and a deep four-pitch mix into one of the safest starter projections in the country. His 95 innings and 135 strikeouts were among the strongest marks posted by any draft-eligible pitcher in 2026, reinforcing the quality of the underlying arsenal.

The curveball is the centerpiece of the profile and one of the best breaking balls in the class. It generates elite swing-and-miss, serves as the primary finishing pitch, and gives Volantis a legitimate professional out pitch. More importantly, it is not carrying the profile alone. The sinker creates a steady diet of poor contact and ground balls, while the slider provides a distinctly different look that keeps hitters from sitting on one movement pattern. Even the splitter flashes enough promise to project as a useful fourth offering moving forward.

What separates Volantis from many of the left-handers behind him is the certainty of the role. He already handles a starter's workload, already turns lineups over multiple times, and already possesses multiple pitches that project as average or better professional offerings. The arsenal may not be built around premium velocity, but it consistently creates uncomfortable swing decisions through movement diversity, sequencing, and command.

Why #2: Volantis combines one of the best breaking balls in the class with a proven starter's workload and a deep, professional-quality arsenal. The only left-handed pitcher ranked ahead of him offers a stronger combination of present stuff and overall starter projection, but few arms in the country can match Volantis' balance of performance, pitchability, and long-term rotation value.

Number 1: Tomas Valincius, Mississippi State

2026 Stats: 3.50 ERA | 97.2 IP | 1.075 WHIP | 134 K | 20 BB

Best Pitch: Sinker (60/65)

Valincius claims the top spot because he possesses the combination every organization searches for in a professional starter: durability, command, swing-and-miss, and a clear identity. While several left-handed pitchers in the class possess louder individual traits, none pair those traits with the same level of workload, performance, and starter certainty. Nearly 100 innings, 134 strikeouts, and only 20 walks is difficult to ignore, particularly when backed by an arsenal capable of handling hitters from both sides of the plate.

The sinker is the foundation of the profile and one of the best fastballs in the class. It gives him a true carrying pitch that can generate weak contact, ground balls, and occasional swing-and-miss. More importantly, the pitch allows him to dictate at-bats. Right-handed hitters are forced to deal with elite arm-side movement running into their hands, while left-handed hitters must respect the velocity before the ball disappears beneath barrels. Few left-handed pitchers can throw a sinker this hard while maintaining this level of movement and strike throwing.

The slider is the separator. While the sinker creates the foundation, the slider finishes hitters. The pitch provides a legitimate put-away weapon and gives Valincius an answer regardless of handedness. Combined with a quality changeup, it creates a three-pitch mix capable of turning over lineups multiple times and handling a professional starter's workload.

Perhaps the most impressive aspect of the profile is the lack of a glaring weakness. The arsenal is deep, the command is advanced, the workload is proven, and the pitch mix provides answers against both right-handed and left-handed hitters. There may be pitchers in the class with higher ceilings, but there are very few with a clearer path toward remaining in a professional rotation.

Why #1: Valincius combines one of the best fastballs in the class with a legitimate out pitch, a usable third offering, advanced strike throwing, and nearly 100 innings of production. The other left-handed pitchers on this list possess intriguing traits and impressive weapons, but no southpaw in the 2027 class currently offers a more complete starter profile.

Conclusion

Rankings naturally focus on separation. The goal is to determine who belongs at the top, who belongs in the middle, and where meaningful differences begin to appear. What stood out during this process, however, was how difficult those separations became.

The difference between the first pitcher on this list and the tenth is not simply talent. It often is floor. Some pitchers have already proven they can hold a starter's workload. Others possess louder individual tools. A few remain developmental bets whose best baseball likely still sits in front of them. More than anything, the ordering reflects the challenge of balancing present performance against future projection.

Several of the pitchers ranked here will change dramatically over the next season. Some will add velocity. Others will develop a new pitch, move into a rotation, or take a significant step forward with command. A ranking completed more than ten months before draft day is inevitably a snapshot rather than a final answer.

What remains encouraging is that every pitcher included here possesses at least one characteristic that gives him a realistic path toward professional value. Some have frontline starter traits. Others project more comfortably toward the back of a rotation. A few may ultimately end up in relief. The path is different for each arm, but the opportunity is there.

With the left-handed pitchers complete, the next step is evaluating the broader class and identifying which pitchers, regardless of handedness, possess the strongest long-term professional futures. The rankings become more difficult from here. They also become more interesting.